Advanced Punctuation (Set B)

Year 4 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Semicolons: Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The sky darkened. The storm was near.'

Answer: 'The sky darkened; the storm was near.' — a semicolon joins two closely related main clauses that could each stand alone.

Colons: Add a colon to introduce this list: 'The bag contained three things a torch, a map and some rope.'

Answer: 'The bag contained three things: a torch, a map and some rope.' — a colon introduces a list, explanation or example.

Direct speech: Punctuate this direct speech correctly: 'Watch out shouted Leo'

Answer: '"Watch out!" shouted Leo.' — speech marks around the exact words, an exclamation mark inside them, and a lower-case reporting clause after.

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The rain stopped. The sun came out.'
2. Add a colon to introduce the list: 'We need these items a pencil a rubber and a ruler.'
3. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech? A) Tom said, I am ready. B) Tom said, "I am ready." C) Tom said "I am ready" D) "Tom said I am ready." E) Tom said: I am ready.
4. Add brackets to insert this extra detail: 'My cousin born in 2014 loves football.'
5. Underline the correct use of a dash in: 'The trip — though tiring — was wonderful.'
6. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'Can we go now asked Ben'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a colon to introduce a list? A) She packed: a hat, gloves and a scarf. B) She packed a hat: gloves and a scarf. C) She needed three things: time, money and patience. D) She needed: three things. E) The winners were: Alex, Sam and Mo.
8. Which punctuation mark correctly joins these two related sentences: 'He was exhausted ___ he had run ten miles.'? A) comma B) colon C) semicolon D) dash E) full stop with no change
9. Add speech marks to: Stop right there! yelled the guard.
10. Explain what a colon does before a list, using the sentence: 'Bring the following: wellies, a coat and an umbrella.'
11. Which sentence correctly uses a semicolon to join two related main clauses? A) The lights went out; because of the storm. B) The lights went out, the storm was fierce. C) The lights went out; the storm was fierce. D) The lights went out: the storm was fierce. E) The lights went out the storm was fierce.
12. Punctuate this sentence with brackets around the extra information: 'The museum which opens at nine is free today.'
13. Write a short sentence of direct speech with the reporting clause BEFORE the speech, punctuated correctly.

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14. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly punctuate a dash used to add an afterthought? A) The match was close — until the final minute. B) The match was close, until the final minute —. C) The match was close — until the final minute. D) The — match was close until the final minute. E) The game ended in a draw — a fair result.

15. Explain why 'He said "hello"' is missing a capital letter and a full stop, and correct it.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. Join these two related sentences using a semicolon: 'The exam was difficult. Most pupils still passed.'

2. Add a colon to this sentence: 'There was only one explanation he had forgotten his key.'

3. Which sentence correctly punctuates a piece of direct speech split by a reporting clause? A) "I think," said Mia, "we should leave now." B) "I think" said Mia "we should leave now." C) "I think, said Mia, we should leave now." D) I think, said Mia, "we should leave now." E) "I think said Mia we should leave now."

4. Insert dashes to add this extra comment: 'The weather forecast and it is rarely wrong predicted snow.'

5. Explain the difference between using a comma and using a semicolon to join two main clauses, with an example of each.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use brackets for extra (removable) information? A) The bridge (built in 1920) is still standing. B) The bridge built in 1920 (is still standing.) C) The recipe (serves four) takes an hour. D) (The recipe serves four) takes an hour. E) Our teacher (Mr Hughes) is very strict.

7. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'I cannot believe it she whispered we actually won'

8. Which punctuation mark best replaces the gap: 'The verdict was clear ___ the defendant was innocent.'? A) comma B) colon C) apostrophe D) exclamation mark E) hyphen

9. Explain when you would choose a dash rather than a colon to introduce extra information, giving one example of each.

10. Rewrite this sentence using a semicolon instead of 'and': 'The team trained hard, and they deserved to win.'

11. Which sentence correctly punctuates a question within direct speech? A) She asked, "Are we late?" B) She asked "Are we late"? C) She asked, "Are we late"? D) She asked: "Are we late?" E) She asked, Are we late?

12. Add a colon to introduce an explanation in: 'There was a simple reason for his lateness the bus never arrived.'

13. Select ALL that apply. Which of these correctly use a semicolon rather than a comma to join two independent clauses? A) She loves reading; he prefers films. B) She loves reading, he prefers films. C) It was cold; we still went outside. D) It was cold, we still went outside. E) The shop closed early; customers were disappointed.

14. Write one sentence that correctly uses a colon to introduce a single dramatic statement (not a list).

15. Explain why brackets, dashes and commas can all sometimes be used to mark off the same piece of extra information, giving one sentence punctuated three different ways.

Red — Challenge (15 questions)

1. Join these two sentences with a semicolon: 'The bell rang. Everyone stood up.'

2. Which sentence correctly uses a colon before a list that is introduced by a complete independent clause? A) We packed: trainers, a towel and sun cream. B) We packed trainers: a towel and sun cream. C) We packed everything we needed: trainers, a towel and sun cream. D) We needed: everything. E) We packed trainers, a towel: and sun cream.

3. Correct this comma splice: 'The sun came out, we went outside to play.'

4. Add brackets around the extra, removable information: 'Our head teacher Mrs Patel is retiring this summer.'

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5. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use a semicolon to join two related main clauses? A) The storm passed; the sky cleared. B) The storm passed, the sky cleared. C) She loves maths; he prefers art. D) She loves maths, he prefers art. E) It was late; we carried on walking.

6. Punctuate this direct speech, which has the reporting clause BEFORE the words spoken: 'Mum called wash your hands before dinner'

7. Which sentence correctly uses a pair of dashes to add an interruption? A) The plan — surprisingly worked perfectly. B) The plan surprisingly — worked perfectly. C) The plan — surprisingly — worked perfectly. D) The — plan surprisingly worked perfectly —. E) The plan surprisingly worked — perfectly.

8. Explain what a colon introduces before a list, using the sentence: 'She needed three things: a map, a torch and some water.'

9. Correct this sentence, which has a missing colon: 'There was one reason for the delay the bus broke down.'

10. Which sentence correctly punctuates direct speech split by a reporting clause? A) 'I think,' said Tom, 'we should go home.' B) 'I think' said Tom 'we should go home.' C) 'I think, said Tom, we should go home.' D) I think, said Tom, 'we should go home.' E) 'I think said Tom we should go home.'

11. Write one sentence that correctly uses a colon to introduce a short list of three items.

12. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly use brackets for extra information that could be removed? A) The film (which won an award) was excellent. B) The film which won an award (was excellent.) C) Our dog (a spaniel) loves the park. D) (Our dog a spaniel) loves the park. E) The bridge (built in 1950) is still used.

13. Punctuate this speech correctly: 'Watch out shouted the coach'

14. Explain the difference between a semicolon and a comma when joining two complete sentences, giving one example.

15. Rewrite this sentence using a semicolon instead of 'and': 'The rain stopped, and the children ran outside.'

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